25901923 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION, Special examination, July 2026

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPSY201 – CHILD DEVELOPMENT

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS) Maximum Marks: 50

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 marks

1. According to the cephalocaudal principle, which of the following sequences best represents the order of development? [U] / [CO1]

c) Head → Arms → Legs

2. The adaptation process include which of the following? [K] / [CO3]

c) Both Assimilation and Accommodation

3. Babies are responding to pain with which of the following: [U] / [CO2]

d) All the above

4. Which system includes direct relationships with parents, peers, and teachers? [U] / [CO3]

a) Microsystem

5. A child grows normally again after illness. This is called: [An] / [CO2]

b) Catch-up growth

6. The Apgar score is typically assessed at which time points after birth? [K] / [CO2]

b) 1 minute and 5 minutes

7. In ethology, a sign stimulus refers to: [U] / [CO3]

b) A specific cue triggering fixed action patterns

8. Play therapy allows children to: [U] / [CO3]

b) Work off frustrations and cope with conflicts

9. Which of the following perspective focuses on directly observable events? [U] / [CO3]

d) Behaviorism

10. Adjusting speech according to age and status comes under: [U] / [CO3]

b) Pragmatics

11. Emotional display rules specify: [U] / [CO3]

a) When, where, and how it is appropriate to express emotions

12. Scaffolding involves: [U] / [CO3]

a) Temporary, adjustable support that is gradually removed

13. The amygdala mainly helps with: [U] / [CO3]

b) Emotions

14. A child starts acting aggressively after watching a fight of a cartoon character. The character function as a: [U] / [CO3]

a) Model

15. Thomas and Chess's research suggests that children who are initially cautious and require time to adjust to new situations are best described as: [U] / [CO3]

c) Slow to warm up

16. This reflex is elicited by stroking the cheek or around the mouth; infant responds by opening mouth and turning head towards stimulus. [K] / [CO2]

c) Rooting reflex

17. What is the name of the second stage of the psychosocial theory? [U] / [CO3]

c) Autonomy versus shame and doubt

18. What is the second stage of Piaget's moral development theory? [U] / [CO3]

c) Autonomous morality

19. Rothbart's model includes the dimension of: [U] / [CO3]

c) Both A and B

20. Why is a newborn's vision poor at birth? [U] / [CO2]

b) Their eyes are not fully developed

[1 × 20 = 20]

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 3 marks

21. Analyse the role of prescription and non-prescription drugs as teratogens.

[An] / [CO2]

Teratogens are environmental agents that can cause prenatal damage or interfere with normal development. Some prescription drugs taken during pregnancy can cross the placenta and reach the developing organism. The effects depend on the **type and dosage of the drug, duration of exposure and timing of exposure** during prenatal development.

Drug exposure can result in **physical abnormalities, impaired growth, damage to developing organs, brain or nervous-system abnormalities and later behavioural or cognitive problems**. Eg : thalidomide, a prescription drug that, when taken during early pregnancy, was associated with severe limb abnormalities and other congenital defects in developing babies.

Some **non-prescription or over-the-counter drugs** may also produce harmful effects when used without appropriate medical guidance. Eg : aspirin (salicylates), particularly in high doses or later pregnancy, may increase the risk of bleeding and other pregnancy-related complications. Therefore, non-prescription drugs should not automatically be considered harmless during pregnancy.

22. Describe the phallic stage of psychosexual theory in detail. [U] / [CO3]

The **phallic stage** is the **third stage of Freud's psychosexual theory**, occurring approximately between **3 and 6 years of age**. During this stage, the **genital region becomes the primary focus of pleasure**.

According to Freud, children develop unconscious feelings toward the parent of the opposite sex. In boys, this is described as the **Oedipus complex**, involving affection toward the mother and rivalry with the father. In girls, Freud proposed the **Electra complex**, involving affection toward the father and rivalry with the mother. Freud also proposed **penis envy** in girls, referring to the child's awareness of anatomical differences.

The conflicts associated with this stage are resolved through **identification with the same-sex parent**. This identification is considered important for the development of the **superego.**

23. Discuss the factors influencing attachment. [U] / [CO3]

Attachment is influenced by several factors related to the **caregiver, infant and environment**. **Caregiver sensitivity and responsiveness** are important because infants develop stronger and more secure attachments when caregivers respond appropriately and consistently to their needs. The **quality, consistency and emotional availability of caregiving** also influence attachment.

The infant's **temperament** can affect the attachment relationship, as some infants are more adaptable or easily soothed than others. Opportunities for interaction and contact, including regular physical and emotional interaction with the caregiver, are also important. In addition, the **family environment, emotional climate, parental stress, socioeconomic conditions and other environmental circumstances** can influence the quality and security of attachment.

24. What is phonological awareness, and why is it important? [U] / [CO3]

Phonological awareness is the ability to recognize and manipulate the **sound structure of spoken language**. It includes awareness of **rhyming words, syllables, words and**

individual speech sounds or phonemes. Children gradually become able to identify, separate, combine and manipulate these sound units.

Phonological awareness is particularly important for literacy development because it helps children understand the relationship between spoken sounds and written symbols. It provides an important foundation for learning to read and spell, as children learn to recognize and manipulate the sounds represented by letters and words.

25. Explain the permissive parenting style with example. [U] / [CO3]

The **permissive parenting style** is characterized by **high warmth and responsiveness** but relatively **low demandingness and control**. Permissive parents are affectionate and accepting but place **few rules, demands and limits** on their children. They may provide considerable freedom and exercise relatively little discipline or supervision.

Such parents may sometimes behave more like a **friend than an authority figure**. As a result, children may have difficulty developing self-control when clear and consistent boundaries are lacking.

Example: A parent may allow a child to decide bedtime, homework and recreational activities without setting consistent rules or consequences, even when the child does not fulfil responsibilities.

26. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of any 2 prenatal diagnostic tests.

[K] / [CO2]

Amniocentesis: It involves removing a small amount of **amniotic fluid** using a needle and examining fetal cells. It can help identify certain **chromosomal abnormalities and genetic disorders**, such as **Down syndrome and some inherited conditions**. Its advantage is that it provides relatively detailed **diagnostic information**. However, it is an **invasive procedure** and carries a small **risk of complications, including miscarriage**.

Chorionic Villus Sampling (CVS): It involves obtaining a sample of **chorionic villi from the placenta** and examining the fetal genetic material. It can identify certain **chromosomal and genetic disorders** and has the advantage of providing diagnostic information **relatively early in pregnancy**. Its disadvantage is that it is **invasive** and carries a small risk of **pregnancy-related complications, including miscarriage**.

Students may explain any two appropriate prenatal diagnostic tests, such as ultrasound, amniocentesis or chorionic villus sampling (CVS),NIPT etc with scientifically correct advantages and disadvantages can also be accepted.

27. According to Piaget how the cognitive ability of a 10 year old child differs from that of a 5 year old child ? [U] / [CO3]

According to **Piaget**, a **5-year-old child** is generally in the **preoperational stage (2–7 years)**. The child can use **symbolic thought and language**, but logical operations are not yet fully developed. The child may show **egocentrism**, difficulty taking another person's perspective and difficulty understanding **conservation** because thinking is strongly influenced by perceptual appearance.

A **10-year-old child** is generally in the **concrete operational stage (7–11 years)**. The child can perform **logical operations on concrete objects and events** and develops an understanding of **conservation, classification, seriation and reversibility**. The child is also better able to consider different aspects of a situation and understand another person's perspective.Thus, the 10-year-old demonstrates more **logical, organized and flexible thinking** than the 5-year-old.

28. Explain why balanced diets help both growth and learning. [An] / [CO2]

A **balanced diet** supplies essential nutrients such as **proteins, carbohydrates, fats, vitamins and minerals**, which are necessary for **physical growth, tissue development and normal body functioning**. Adequate nutrition is especially important during childhood because the body and brain undergo rapid development.

Nutrition also has an important role in **brain development and cognitive functioning**. Adequate nutrients support **attention, memory, concentration and learning**. For example, inadequate nutrition can contribute to **fatigue, poor concentration and reduced school performance**. Nutritional deficiencies may also interfere with normal physical and cognitive development. Thus, a balanced diet supports both healthy physical growth and effective learning.

29. Explain in short, the post conventional level in Kohlberg's theory. [U] / [CO3]

The **post-conventional level** is the **third and highest level** in Kohlberg's theory of moral development. At this level, moral reasoning is based on **internalized principles and personal moral standards**, rather than simply on avoiding punishment, obtaining rewards or gaining social approval.

It consists of **Stage 5 – Social Contract and Individual Rights**, in which individuals recognize that laws are **social agreements** designed to protect people's rights and welfare and may be changed when they are unjust. **Stage 6 – Universal Ethical Principles** involves reasoning according to broader principles such as **justice, equality and respect for human dignity**.

30. Describe the concept of temperament and its significance in child development. [U] / [CO3]

Temperament refers to relatively stable, biologically influenced individual differences in **emotional reactivity, activity level and self-regulation**. Children differ in characteristics such as **activity level, emotional intensity, adaptability, attention and approach or withdrawal**.

Temperament influences how children **respond to people, situations and changes in their environment**. It does not determine development by itself; rather, it interacts with **parenting and environmental experiences**. **Goodness of fit** refers to how well the child's temperament matches the expectations and demands of the environment. A good fit between the child's characteristics and the environment can promote better adjustment and positive development.

31. What are the survival role of new born reflexes? [K] / [CO2]

Newborn reflexes are **automatic and involuntary responses** to particular stimuli and serve important **survival and adaptive functions** during early infancy.

The **rooting reflex** helps the infant turn toward stimulation around the mouth and locate the nipple, while the **sucking reflex** enables the infant to obtain nourishment. The **Moro reflex**, which occurs in response to sudden stimulation or a sensation of falling, produces a characteristic protective response. The **grasping reflex** may also have an early adaptive function. In addition to survival functions, newborn reflexes provide important information about the infant's **neurological health and maturation** because their presence, strength and disappearance follow characteristic developmental patterns.

[3x10 = 30]